

Survey Design Seminar

Survey Methods 670

Winter 2026

Week 4: Project Management

January 29, 2026

Outline of Today's Class

- A. Alternative workspaces
- B. Organizing work
- C. Organizing literature reviews

A. Alternative workspaces

- Space and privacy
 - Office at home
- Privacy?



" IT MUST BE NICE HAVING A JOB
WHERE YOU CAN WORK AT HOME. "

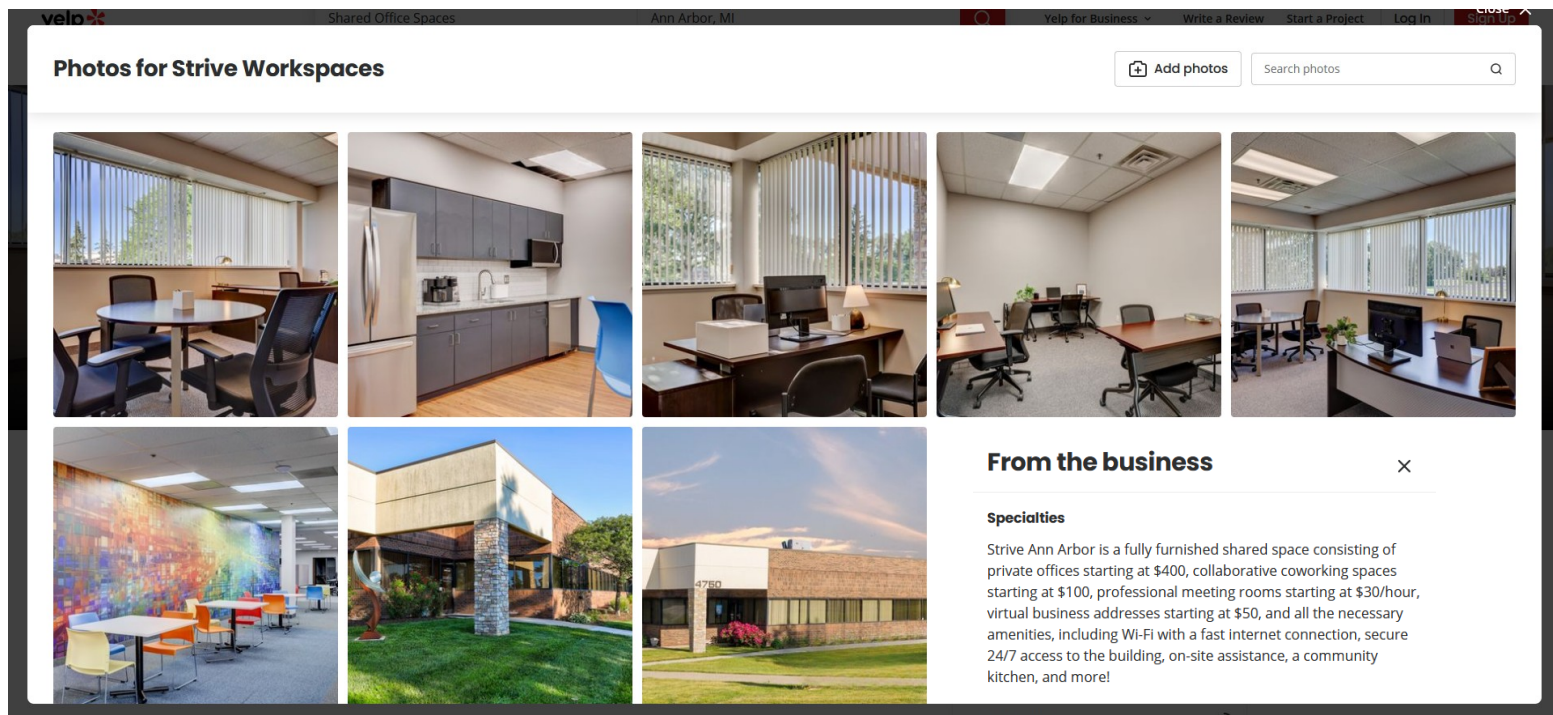
A. Alternative workspaces

- Shared space
Privacy?



A. Alternative workspaces

- Shared space
Privacy?



A. Alternative workspaces

- Formal office
 - Initial investment
 - Rent, equipment, other overhead?
 - Productivity and performance

A. Alternative workspaces

- Formal office
 - Initial investment
 - Productivity and performance
- Essential equipment
 - Telephone/Fax lines (<https://callin.io/telephone-reception-service-everything-you-should-know-about-this-service/>)
 - Internet connection
 - Computer
 - Printer/Scanner/Copier/Duplicating Facility
 - Postage meter/ electronic scale (or do PDF attachments eliminate this)??

B. Hiring Help (Depending on Size): Consultants for Consultants

- Grant proposals
 - Editing assistance
 - Graphical assistance
 - Budgeting
- Contract work
 - Announcement
 - Job descriptions
 - Interviews
 - Subcontracts for certain services
 - Payroll and accounting

Advertising for Help

The screenshot displays a web browser window with the URL www.indeed.com/q-Research-Assistant-jobs.html?vjk=23107884362b0980. The browser's address bar and tabs are visible at the top. The main content area features a job listing for 'ABCD Research Assistant' at the University of Michigan, which is a 4.3-star rated employer. The job is located at 503 Thompson Street, Ann Arbor, MI 48109, and is a temporary, part-time position. A note indicates that users must create an Indeed account to apply. The listing includes a blue 'Apply on company site' button and icons for bookmarking and sharing. Below the job details is a 'Profile insights' section with two questions: 'Do you have experience in Psychology research?' and 'Do you have a Bachelor's degree?', each with 'Yes' and 'No' response buttons. The left sidebar contains a 'Create a profile on Indeed' prompt, a filter for 'What are your desired job types?' with options for Full-time, Part-time, Contract, and Temporary, and a list of filters for 'Pay information not provided', 'Full-time', 'Health insurance', 'Vision insurance', and 'Dental insurance'.

www.indeed.com/q-Research-Assistant-jobs.html?vjk=23107884362b0980

Media Imported From Firefox Cheap Flights, Cheap ... Adobe Acrobat 'It sounds like a war z... University of Michigan eBay Imported From Firefox YouTube

Pay information not provided Full-time Health insurance Vision insurance Dental insurance

Clinical Research Technician/Assistant

University of Michigan
Ann Arbor, MI 48109

Pay information not provided Full-time Monday to Friday +3 Health insurance Vision insurance Dental insurance

Create a profile on Indeed

What are your desired job types? *

☐ Full-time

☐ Part-time

☐ Contract

☐ Temporary

ABCD Research Assistant

University of Michigan • 4.3 ★

503 Thompson Street, Ann Arbor, MI 48109

Temporary, Part-time

You must create an Indeed account before continuing to the company website to apply

Apply on company site

Profile insights

Find out how your skills align with the job description

Skills

Do you have experience in **Psychology research**? Yes No

Education

Do you have a **Bachelor's degree**? Yes No

Job details

<https://www.indeed.com/q-Research-Assistant-jobs.html?vjk=23107884362b0980>

Advertising for Help



☰ The New York Times Account ▾

Genetic Data From Over 20,000 U.S. Children Misused for 'Race Science'

The National Institutes of Health failed to protect brain scans that an international group of fringe researchers used to argue for the intellectual superiority of white people.

<https://www.nytimes.com/2026/01/24/us/children-genetics-race-science.html>

Components of Job Descriptions

- Task description
- Timeline
- Required qualifications
- Desired qualifications
- Fee or rate
- Application materials and submission

Interviewing Applicants

Datassist Interview Questions

Question 1. What are the top three types of statistical methods or techniques you enjoy using?

Question 2. What do you like best about working with data?

Question 3. In a multiple regression of Y on three predictors, X_1 , X_2 and X_3 , if the coefficients of both X_2 and X_3 , are not significant, is it safe to drop these two variable and perform a regression on X_1 alone? Discuss in a way a client would understand.

Question 4. In a regression model with two predictors X_1 and X_2 , and an interaction term between the two predictors, how do you interpret the 'main' effects of X_1 and X_2 when the model includes an interaction term that is significant? Discuss in a way a non-technical client would understand.

Question 5: If you were asked to do an analysis that was meant to be through a "gender lens" and the covariate for gender was not significant what would you do?

Organizing & Writing a Proposal

- General form and content
- Technical capacity
- Administrative requirements
- Budgeting

Organizing & Writing a Proposal:

General form and content

Is there a prescribed format – sections, headings, etc.?

Is there a page length?

Does the client want a single proposed design or alternatives?

Is there an indication of a maximum budget? Or a range of costs?

Do you have to supply assurances and guarantees?

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Introduction/Literature Review

Why the problem is important

- Can't be a list
- Subjective expert review
- Aiming to solve a problem/filling a gap
- Presenting evidence for the parts of a solution
- Historical view could be relevant or irrelevant
- Peer reviewed vs. not
- Combination of theory and empirical evidence
 - Methodology
 - Application to substantive research
 - Equally important under all essential data collection conditions

Organizing & Writing a Proposal:

A single design or alternatives

Will the client permit more than one approach?

How will you frame your design:

- For an announced maximum budget, here is the best solution
- For the approach you prefer, here is a low-cost way to accomplish it
- There is more than one way to approach a solution, and here are the tradeoffs (cost vs. data quality)

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Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Budgeting

What is “salary”?

What are “data collection costs”?

A “Supply” or a “Subaward”?

What are “indirect costs/overhead”?

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Budgeting

What is **salary**?

Hourly wages vs. salary

Taxes and fringe benefits

Federal Insurance Contributions Act (FICA)

Social Security

Retirement contributions

Health care

Paid vacation

Family leave

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Budgeting

What are **data collection costs**?

Global estimate or cost per unit?

What does an interview cost?

Hint: 4 to 6 times interview length

Associated travel costs

What is the field period?

Calculation involves interviews/day, size of interviewing staff (which may be adjustable)

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Budgeting

What is involved conducting 1,000 30-minute interviews?

500 hours of interviewer time?

3,000 hours of interviewer time?

How long will it take?

20-station CATI facility, 9-hour shifts = 16.67 days

If you have 14 days for the project, you need at least
24 stations

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Budgeting

What are **indirect costs/overhead**?

Costs that cannot be charged directly to the client and you do not want to account for on each project

Space

Utilities

Administrative staff

Equipment??

Supplies??

Why **maximize or minimize** IDC?

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Assurances

BUDGET

A budget detailing how the requested funds will be used must accompany all grant requests.

General Support Requests: the organization's **institutional budget** will suffice; an additional budget is not required.

REQUIRED Supporting Materials

All Applicants

- Copy of the organization's **current institutional budget**
- **Sources of institutional support** (if not mentioned in the above), including pending requests
- List of **Board members**, including their affiliations
- **Diversity Form** (link can be found here: <http://www.rbf.org/content/apply-grant>)

First-time applicants also have to submit documentation of their tax status and a copy of their most recent audited financial statements; your program contact will advise you on what is required.

Format

There is no minimum or maximum length requirement for the proposal; however, the RBF has found that 3 to 10 pages is an adequate range. Please be concise.

Submission of Materials

The RBF strongly prefers to receive electronic versions of proposal materials. These should be e-mailed directly to your program contact at the Fund. Electronic submission of proposal materials, however, is not a requirement, and you will not be penalized if you do not have access to e-mail. If you are unable to send the materials electronically, please send hard copies. **Please do not send both electronic and hard copies of your proposal materials.**

Additional Materials

Materials such as press coverage, brochures, annual reports, DVDs, or CD-ROMs are not required for review of the proposal and will be requested by RBF program staff if needed.

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Assurances

The screenshot displays the University of Michigan Research Ethics & Compliance website. At the top, a navigation bar includes links for Office of Research, OVPR Units, Research & Sponsored Projects, Research Ethics & Compliance, eResearch, and Finance-Sponsored Programs. The main header features the University of Michigan logo and the text "RESEARCH ETHICS & COMPLIANCE UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN". A yellow "COMPLIANCE HOTLINE" button is located on the right. Below the header, a horizontal menu lists various research areas: ANIMAL CARE & USE, HUMAN SUBJECTS, HUMAN PLURIPOTENT STEM CELLS, RESEARCH SAFETY, RESEARCH INTEGRITY, CONFLICT OF INTEREST, CONTROLLED SUBSTANCES (highlighted), EXPORT CONTROLS, and RESEARCH INFORMATION SECURITY. A search icon is also present.

Below the menu, a semi-circular diagram illustrates the "PROJECT LIFECYCLE" within "Research Ethics & Compliance". The cycle consists of six steps: Find Funding (red), Develop Proposal (yellow), Route & Submit Proposal (blue), Set Up Project (orange), Manage Project (teal), and Close Out Project (purple).

To the right of the diagram, a "Welcome" message is partially visible, followed by a list of topics under the "CONTROLLED SUBSTANCES" dropdown menu: POLICIES, SOM LICENSE - APPLY & RENEW, DEA REGISTRATION - APPLY & RENEW, ORDERING & RECEIVING, SECURITY & STORAGE CONTROLS, CONTROLLED SUBSTANCE RECORDS, DISPOSAL, REPORT THEFT/SIGNIFICANT LOSS, LICENSE/REGISTRATION CHANGES, and INSPECTION PREPARATION.

At the bottom, a dark blue banner titled "Core Principles of U-M Research Compliance" lists four principles:

- 1 Foster ethical conduct
- 2 Ensure compliance with federal and state regulations
- 3 Define U-M compliance guidelines
- 4 Safeguard U-M researchers and research

A small URL "iance.umich.edu/controlled-substances-research" is visible at the bottom left of the banner.

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Assurances

University of Michigan

FEDERALWIDE ASSURANCE OF PROTECTION FOR HUMAN SUBJECTS

FWA 00004969

FWA Expiration: Date changes frequently; check the OHRP FWA database for the expiration date (<http://ohrp.cit.nih.gov/search/fwasearch.aspx?styp=bsc>)

1. Human Subject Research Will be Guided by Ethical Principles

With regard to federally-conducted or -sponsored research, all of the University's activities and all activities of the Institutional Review Boards (IRBs) designated under this Assurance will be guided by the ethical principles in The Belmont Report: Ethical Principles and Guidelines for the Protection of Human Subject of Research of the National Commission for the Protection of Human Subjects of Biomedical and Behavioral Research.

2. Applicability

These terms apply whenever the University becomes engaged in federally supported* (i.e., conducted or supported) human subjects research, which is not otherwise exempt from the Federal Policy for the Protection of Human Subjects. The University becomes so engaged whenever:

- a. The University's employees or agents intervene or interact with human subjects for purposes of federally-supported research;
- b. The University's employees or agents obtain individually identifiable private information about human subjects for purposes of federally-supported research; or
- c. The University receives a direct federal award to conduct human subject research, even where a subcontractor or collaborator carries out all activities involving human subjects.

*"Federally supported" is defined in this document and in the FWA as the U.S. Government providing any funding or other support (including, but not limited to, providing supplies, products, drugs, and identifiable private information collected for research purposes) and/or the conduct of the research involves U.S. Government employees.

3. Compliance with the Federal Policy for the Protection of Human Subjects

In its conduct of federally-supported human subjects research, the University and the IRB(s) designated under this Assurance will comply with the Federal Policy for the Protection of Human Subjects, known as the Common Rule. All federally supported human subject research will also comply with any additional human subject regulations and policies of the supporting Department or Agency. All human subjects research conducted or supported by the Department of Health and Human Services (DHHS) will comply with all

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Assurances

Institutional Review Board (IRB)

The screenshot shows a web browser window displaying the University of Michigan Research Ethics & Compliance website. The browser's address bar shows the URL: <https://research-compliance.umich.edu/irb-health-sciences-and-behavioral-sciences-hsbs>. The website header includes the University of Michigan logo and the text "RESEARCH ETHICS & COMPLIANCE UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN". A navigation menu lists various categories: ANIMAL CARE & USE, HUMAN SUBJECTS, HUMAN PLURIPOTENT STEM CELLS, RESEARCH SAFETY, RESEARCH INTEGRITY, CONFLICT OF INTEREST, CONTROLLED SUBSTANCES, EXPORT CONTROLS, RESEARCH INFORMATION SECURITY, and a COMPLIANCE HOTLINE button. The main content area is titled "IRB Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences (HSBS)". It includes a section "About the Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences IRB (IRB-HSBS)" which states that the IRB-HSBS is responsible for protecting the rights and welfare of human subjects. A "WHAT IS AN IRB?" section explains that an IRB is an independent committee made up of at least five members. A "RELATED INFORMATION" section features a circular diagram of the "PROJECT LIFECYCLE" with steps: Find Funding, Develop Proposal, Route & Submit Proposal, Set Up Project, Manage Project, and Close Out Project. Below this, there is a link to "NEW! GUIDELINES FOR THE IRB-HSBS REVIEW OF ROUTINE FMRI STUDIES". At the bottom, there is a section for "U-M HRPP Operations Manual IRB References" and a link to the "IRB-HSBS GUIDANCE PAGE".

Chapter 6 Figures and Tables - x Files x University of Michigan x IRB Health Sciences and Behav x +

https://research-compliance.umich.edu/irb-health-sciences-and-behavioral-sciences-hsbs

Getting Started Most Visited Email https://ctools.umich.e... Blue Jeans Network | V... Axios Getting Started Getting Started Getting Started

Office of Research UMOR Units Research & Sponsored Projects Research Ethics & Compliance eResearch Finance-Sponsored Programs

M RESEARCH ETHICS & COMPLIANCE UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN COMPLIANCE HOTLINE

ANIMAL CARE & USE HUMAN SUBJECTS HUMAN PLURIPOTENT STEM CELLS RESEARCH SAFETY RESEARCH INTEGRITY CONFLICT OF INTEREST CONTROLLED SUBSTANCES EXPORT CONTROLS RESEARCH INFORMATION SECURITY

Home / Human Subjects / IRB Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences (HSBS)

IRB Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences (HSBS)

About the Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences IRB (IRB-HSBS)

The **Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences Institutional Review Board (IRB-HSBS)** is responsible for protecting the rights and welfare of human subjects participating in research conducted by faculty, staff and students affiliated with the University of Michigan – Ann Arbor Campus as well as the Dearborn and Flint Campuses (see [list of supported units](#)).

The IRB-HSBS:

1. **Reviews and oversees research** to ensure that it meets ethical principles and complies with federal regulations, state laws, and university policies (see [HRPP Policies](#))
2. Assists researchers in the design and conduct of sound research in support of U-M's mission to develop and disseminate new knowledge in the public interest

WHAT IS AN IRB?

An IRB is an *independent committee* made up of at least five (5) members from the academic disciplines for which it has oversight and at least one member who is not affiliated with the institution. The membership:

- Comes primarily from faculty
- May also include students, staff and members of the community
- Must have the expertise and experience to evaluate proposed research projects
- Must be diverse in terms of race, gender and cultural backgrounds

RELATED INFORMATION

YOU ARE HERE:

Find Funding Develop Proposal Route & Submit Proposal Set Up Project Manage Project Close Out Project

PROJECT LIFECYCLE

Research Ethics & Compliance

NEW! GUIDELINES FOR THE IRB-HSBS REVIEW OF ROUTINE FMRI STUDIES

Review the criteria for the IRB application and review, download the fMRI informed consent template and master protocol, and more.

[Go to Guidelines](#)

U-M HRPP Operations Manual IRB References

IRB organization, authority: [Part 2, Section II, C](#)

IRB jurisdiction: [Part 5, Section I, A-D](#)

IRB-HSBS GUIDANCE PAGE

IRB-HSBS BOARDS

The IRB-HSBS consists of two (2) boards led by the IRB Chair, Thad Polk, Ph.D., who is supported by Vice Chairs Riann Palmieri-Smith and Rob Hymes. Each board meets monthly. Designated IRB members also conduct **expedited review** of applications on a rolling basis. Each board includes faculty representatives from U-M Dearborn.

9:27 PM 2/8/2020

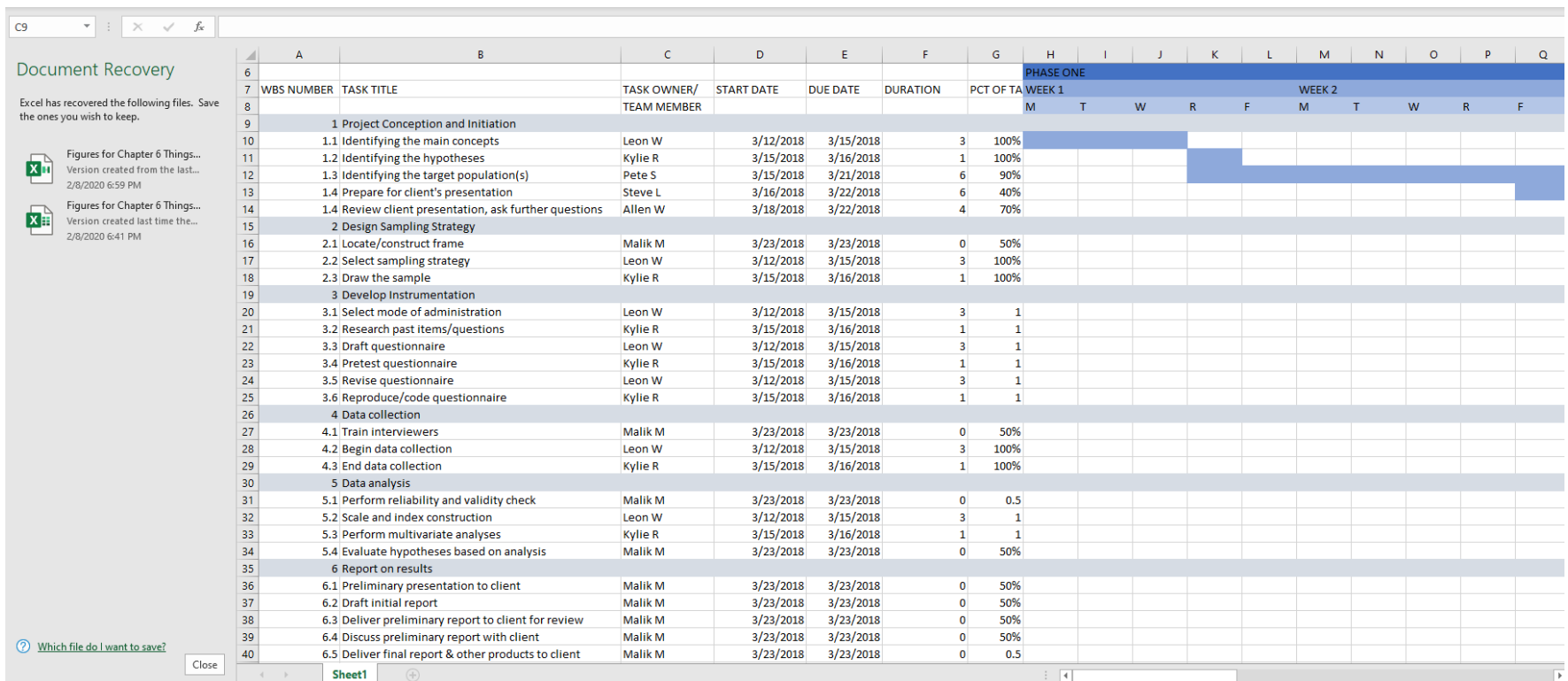
Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Assurances

Institutional Review Board (IRB)

The screenshot shows the Pearl IRB website homepage. The browser address bar displays <https://www.pearlirb.com>. The website features a dark blue header with navigation links: Home, About, Get Started, Services, Resources, Blog, and Consulting Services. The main content area has a background image of two people looking at a document. On the left, the text reads: "Efficient. Ethical. Experienced." followed by "Superior central independent review board services that effectively balance the needs of human subjects, sponsors, and sites." On the right, there are two call-to-action boxes: "Get Started" with a speech bubble icon and "Follow the step-by-step guide.", and "Forms" with a document icon and "Download forms now." At the bottom, there are three icons representing the IRB's values: "NIMBLE" (a clock icon), "INDEPENDENT" (a group of people icon), and "ETHICAL" (a circular seal icon). The footer includes the URL <https://www.pearlirb.com/statement-of-compliance/> and a Windows taskbar at the bottom showing the time as 9:11 PM on 2/8/2020.

Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Planning and tracking the effort

The GANTT Chart



Organizing & Writing a Proposal: Planning and tracking the effort

Some hints

- Rows are the tasks with staff assignments; columns indicate elapsed time or chronology
- Time should be represented with two levels of granularity
 - Longer projects: months and weeks, years and quarters
 - Shorter projects: months and weeks, weeks and days

Organizing & Writing a Proposal:

Planning and tracking the effort

In the proposal

- Shows you have a command of the project (use of software)
- Indicates the relevant amount of effort devoted to each task (time and staff)
- Gives a sense of the deliverables timetable

During the project

- Makes responsibilities clear
- Makes the schedule for deliverables clear
- Indicates where and when adjustments are necessary

Preparing for Client Interactions

Identify the problem from client's perspective

Think about the key dimensions of measurement with regard to the solution(s)

What are the key concepts? How can they be operationalized or measured?

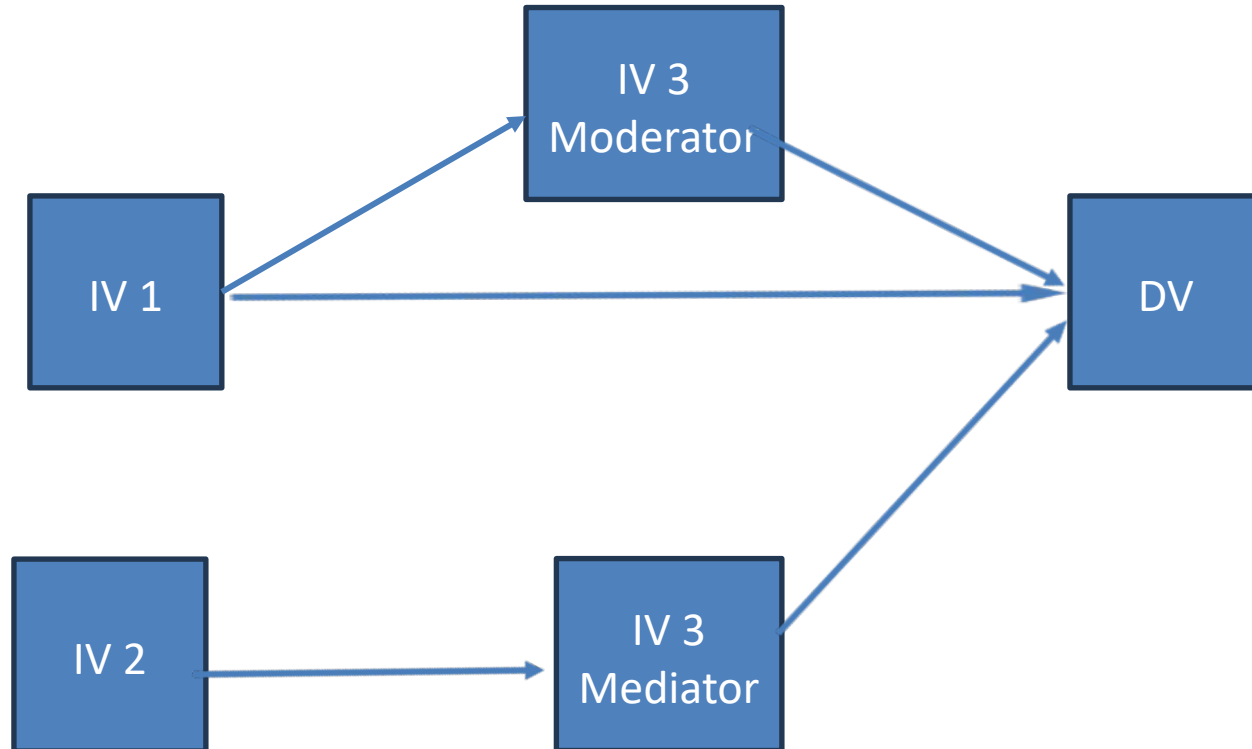
What are the appropriate units of analysis (populations)? Do they require sampling?

Combining operationalizations and populations: how many different approaches to a solution are there?

Education of the client conceptually

Preparing for Client Interactions

Think about preparing a **Conceptual Arrow Diagram**



Preparing for Client Interactions

Identify the problem from client's perspective

Think about the key dimensions of measurement with regard to the solution(s)

What are the key concepts? How can they be operationalized or measured?

What are the appropriate units of analysis (populations)? Do they require sampling?

Combining operationalizations and populations: how many different approaches to a solution are there?

Education of the client conceptually

Preparing for Client Interactions

What is the range of possible solutions?

Which are feasible given the available resources?

Select the one (or two?) you want to pursue with an eye to what you can accomplish

Be prepared to discuss with the client the path you want to pursue and explanations for why

This could be a short prioritized list, allowing for speedier than expected progress

Example 1: Annotated Bibliography

A substantive compilation of what we know about the problem from prior research:

- Types of models or theories used

- Main concepts employed

A review of important methodological issues in prior research (annotated and with comments):

- Examples of items and questionnaires

 - Form, scales, order, etc.

- Issues of selection of units

 - Frames (available or not), sample designs

Example 2: Suggested Data Collection

Preliminary forms of data collection

- Draft items

- Draft questionnaire

- Focus group script

- Cognitive interview script/work

- Pretest (timing, evaluation of items)

Proposed final design for data collection

Analysis plan

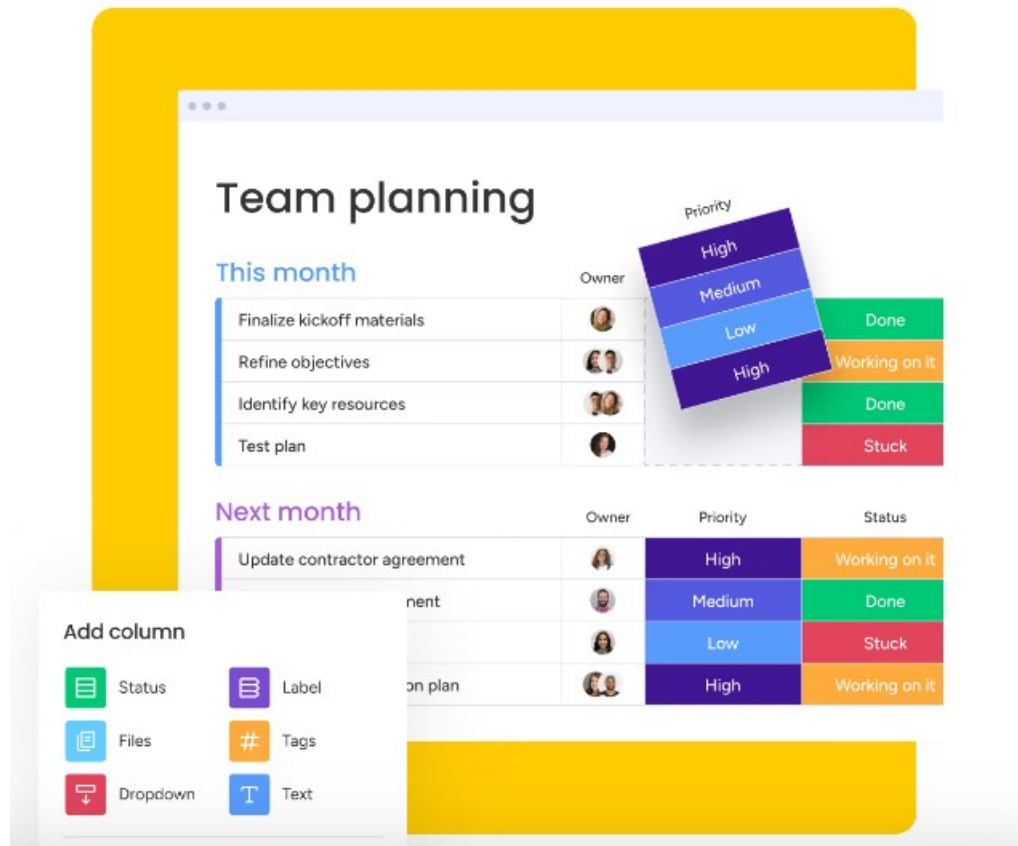
Report outline

B. Project Management

- Combination of Size / Content / Expertise
- Multiple people
 - Previous experience
 - Referral
- Outsourcing, if indicated
- Quality / Time / Budget
- Special software for Project Management

B. Project Management

- **Special software for Project Management: Monday.com as an example**



Outlook for Upcoming Week

- For Week 6:
 - Progress report (Assignment 2)
 - Practice presentations to clients
 - Meet with instructors during class
- For Week 7:
 - Progress report (Assignment 3) – presentations to clients